

# PREY

## Oh, The Humanity

**P**rey is the story of Tommy, a Cherokee Indian who's all but rejecting his culture, when bigger problems hit him—aliens abduct him, his grandfather and his girlfriend, and take them all aboard the Sphere to be turned into food. Tommy miraculously escapes the assembly line, his girlfriend gets unlucky as she's turned into the Sphere's own plaything, and the grandfather gets even more unlucky in the Sphere's digestive tracts. Now Tommy must save his girlfriend, and while he's at it, the rest of the planet. Yawn. So on goes our little Tommy, blasting away at the alien army, walking on walls, and taking spiritual journeys with ol' grandpa. Soon enough, his abilities grow to include the "Spirit Walk", which lets him leave his physical self and walk around as a spirit. What strange creatures will he encounter? Why is the Sphere here? And why is it playing with his girlfriend? Gripping stuff, I tell you.

Right from the outset, *Prey* looks good, and the environment design is impressive. One fun feature is gravity flipping, where you change the direction of gravity by shooting at the...well...gravity flipper. This gets you pretty disoriented and has been known to cause motion sickness—if that isn't motivation to try it out, I don't know what is. There, sadly, ends the good part. The game's weird level design and bells and whistles like gravity flipping and wall-walking, while fun for a bit, seem to be there to disorient you into believing that this is a good game, but at its heart, it isn't.

The story is stupid when it starts out, and provides little motivation to continue. It picks up later, but that's a relative term. The Spirit Walk is pointless—you'd expect to be floating around through walls—at the very least, floating around. Surprise, surprise—your spirit is only slightly less limited than your body—it passes through forcefields and can walk on special spirit walkways, but *it obeys gravity!*

If you're looking for a challenge, you should turn your attention elsewhere. Apart from the few puzzles, *Prey* has little to offer. When you die, you're sent to a spirit realm, where you must shoot down spirits to gain health points to return to the real world, right where you left off. Neat concept—no more quicksaving!

Of course, even if you don't battle the spirits, you still come back with half your health—you *never* die. Which means that if you're faced with twenty foes, you can kill ten, die, come back, kill five more, die again... Call me crazy, but I like the challenge of figuring out how I'm going to eliminate fifty soldiers with just forty percent of my health. If I can just come back and finish the job, why waste energy trying to do it right in the first place? To top it off, there are even markers that tell you when to use the spirit walk. Genius.

*Prey* is the game for you if:

1. You are easily satisfied by vats of blood, miscellaneous gooey substances, and pretty graphics
2. You are brain-dead, and are looking to stay that way

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Rating: **5/10**  
Developer: **3D Realms**  
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Price: **Rs 1299**  
Minimum System Requirements: **Pentium 4 2.0 GHz or AMD Athlon XP 2000+ processor, 512 MB RAM, DirectX 9.0c compatible 64 MB video card**

